level indicators (SLIs). In this first section, we will dive deep into how these three terms interplay and for whom (role-wise) one or more of these terms are relevant.

Figure 10.1 shows how SLAs, SLOs, and SLIs interact, on a high level. We have four personas at work here in two buckets:

- The *service consumer*, or *customer*, typically external to the team, who owns the service (the service boundary line)
- The *service provider*, comprising
  - The *sales team*, who could be on the business side of things, solution engineers, customer success engineers/support people, or a point of contact for the service
  - The *product owner*, who is the person who owns the road map and works with both the sales team and engineering
  - The *engineering team*, who own the service from a feature development and, potentially, operations perspective (though there may be dedicated roles, such as SRE, for that task available in the organization)

It's perfectly possible for the service customer to be within the organization (internal customer); however, that doesn't change the expectations or commitments to them, only the potential flow of money. If the costs of a service are attributed to an internal customer, we call it a *chargeback*. A slightly less extreme form (no actual charges, just cost and usage awareness) of a chargeback is a *showback*, where costs are displayed to internal customers. For our discussion, what matters is that the service customer is outside of the boundaries of the service team.

OK, but what does all of that really mean? What really are SLAs, SLOs, and SLIs, and how should you go about defining and implementing them? Let's start at the bottom of figure 10.1 and work our merry way up. First, let's define what we mean by *service*.

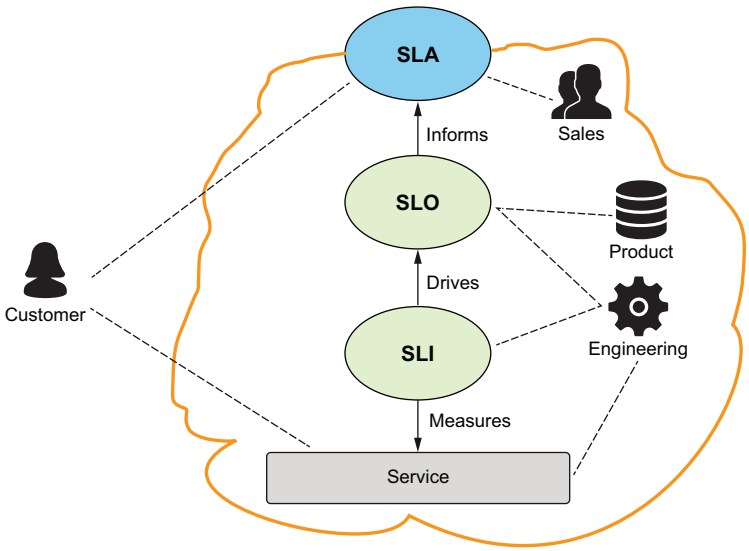


Figure 10.1 Interaction and dependencies between SLAs, SLOs, and SLIs